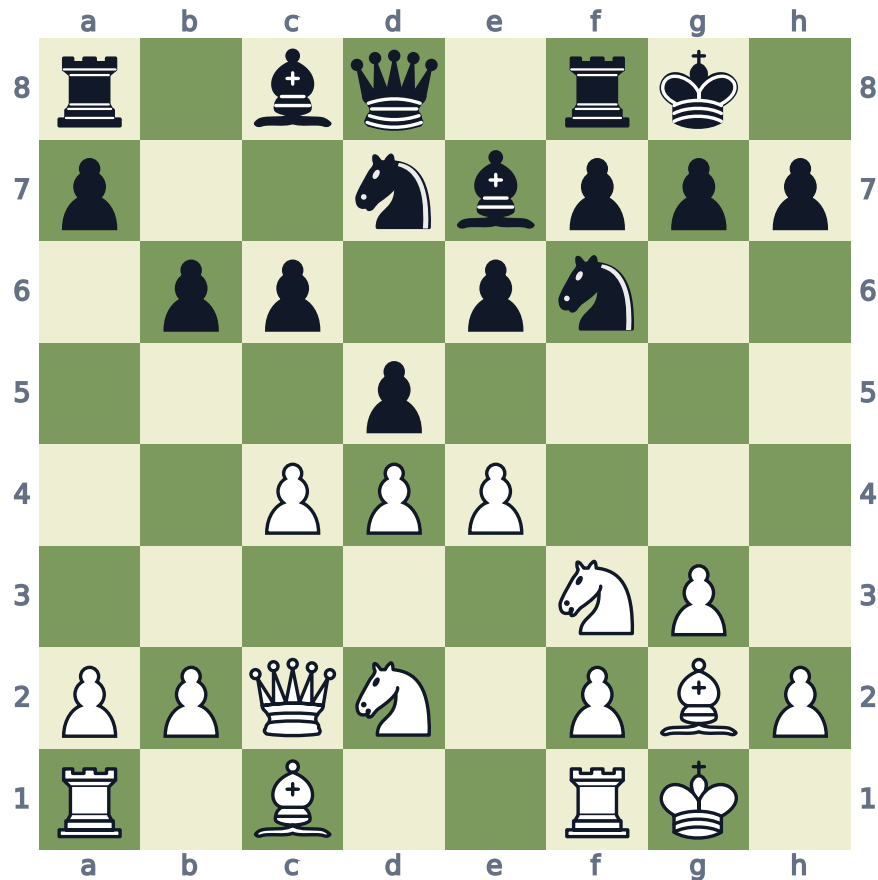


Catalan Repertoire

The g2 bishop, Open and Closed Catalans, pawn recovery, and long-term pressure



Use Catalan development as a complete strategic weapon rather than merely placing a bishop on g2.

8 learning units | diagrams | recall tests | engine-checked analysis

ORIENTATION

How to study this volume

PURPOSE

Use Catalan development as a complete strategic weapon rather than merely placing a bishop on g2.

THE TRAINING LOOP

- First identify Black's defense from pawn placement and move order.
- At every diagram, name the center, the urgent threat, and two candidate moves.
- Hide the recall answer until you have spoken the move and its purpose.
- Replay each line from both sides in Fritz or another board program.
- Review misses after 1, 3, 7, 14, 30, and 60 days.
-

WHAT COMPLETE MEANS HERE

This volume contains 8 units inside a connected White repertoire. It covers the main structural and move-order decisions you need for practical play; the PGN companion makes later updating possible.

STRATEGIC FOUNDATION

Principles 1-3

PRINCIPLE 1

The g2 bishop becomes strong only when the diagonal is opened or Black must defend it.

PRINCIPLE 2

Open Catalans exchange a pawn for time and activity, not permanent material loss.

PRINCIPLE 3

Qc2, Qa4+, and Ne5 are tools for recovering c4 or increasing pressure.

VERIFICATION QUESTION

What would have to be true for one of these principles to be wrong in the current position? Check forcing moves before applying a strategic rule.

STRATEGIC FOUNDATION

Principles 4-6

PRINCIPLE 4

Closed Catalans require preparation of e4 or queenside pressure.

PRINCIPLE 5

Black's ...c5 break challenges White's center and must be met concretely.

PRINCIPLE 6

Small endgame advantages depend on activity, not the opening name.

VERIFICATION QUESTION

What would have to be true for one of these principles to be wrong in the current position? Check forcing moves before applying a strategic rule.

REPERTOIRE MAP

Branches 1-8

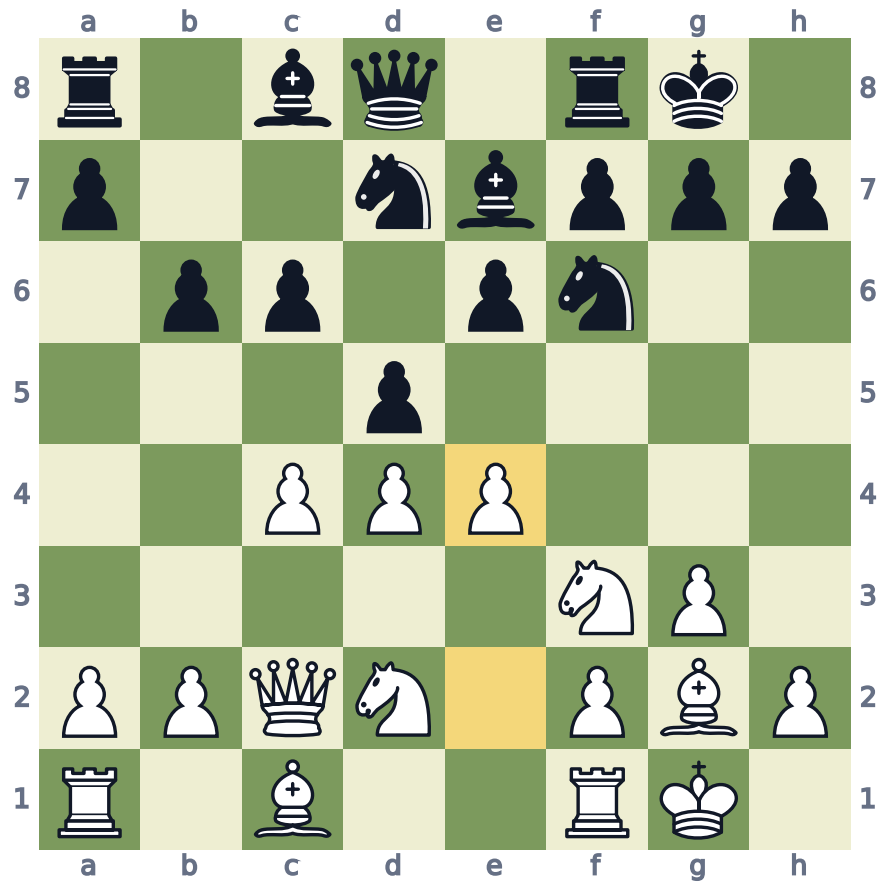
- | | | |
|-----------|--------------------------------|--|
| 01 | Closed Catalan core | Closed center plus g2 bishop means prepare the central release. |
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 | | |
| 02 | Open Catalan recovery | Qc2 eyes c4 and h7 while avoiding early exposure. |
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 | | |
| 03 | Open Catalan with Qa4+ | When Black holds c4 with ...b5, attack the chain with a4 and Ne5. |
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 | | |
| 04 | Catalan ...Bb4+ | Use the check to develop, then decide whether Bf4 or Qc2 improves the bishop. |
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 | | |
| 05 | Catalan ...c5 challenge | Against ...c5, calculate whether dxc5 or maintaining tension improves the bishop. |
|
 | | |
| 06 | Catalan ...b6 | When bishops face each other through d5, the central break decides their strength. |
|
 | | |
| 07 | Early ...dxc4 | Qa4+ can force a blocking move and regain c4 immediately. |
|
 | | |
| 08 | Catalan endgame route | Open Catalans often trade short-term material for durable squares and diagonals. |

NAVIGATION RULE

Identify the pawn structure first, then confirm the move order. A familiar position reached by a different sequence should trigger the same plan.

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 01

Closed Catalan core



COURSE LINE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 e6 3. Nf3 d5 4. g3 Be7 5. Bg2 O-O 6. O-O Nbd7 7. Qc2 c6 8. Nbd2 b6 9. e4

WHITE'S IDEA

Complete the fianchetto and prepare e4 while the center remains closed.

MAIN DANGER

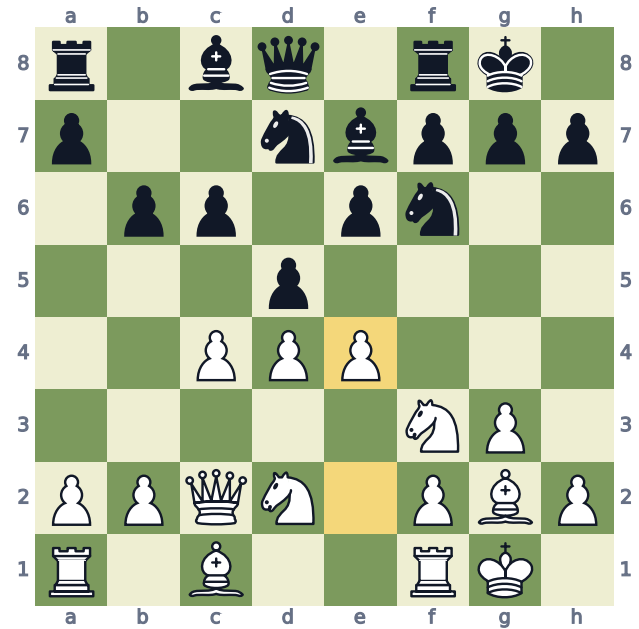
e4 without enough support can lose d4 or permit ...dxe4.

BRANCH LOGIC 01

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 8 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

Closed center plus g2 bishop means prepare the central release.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

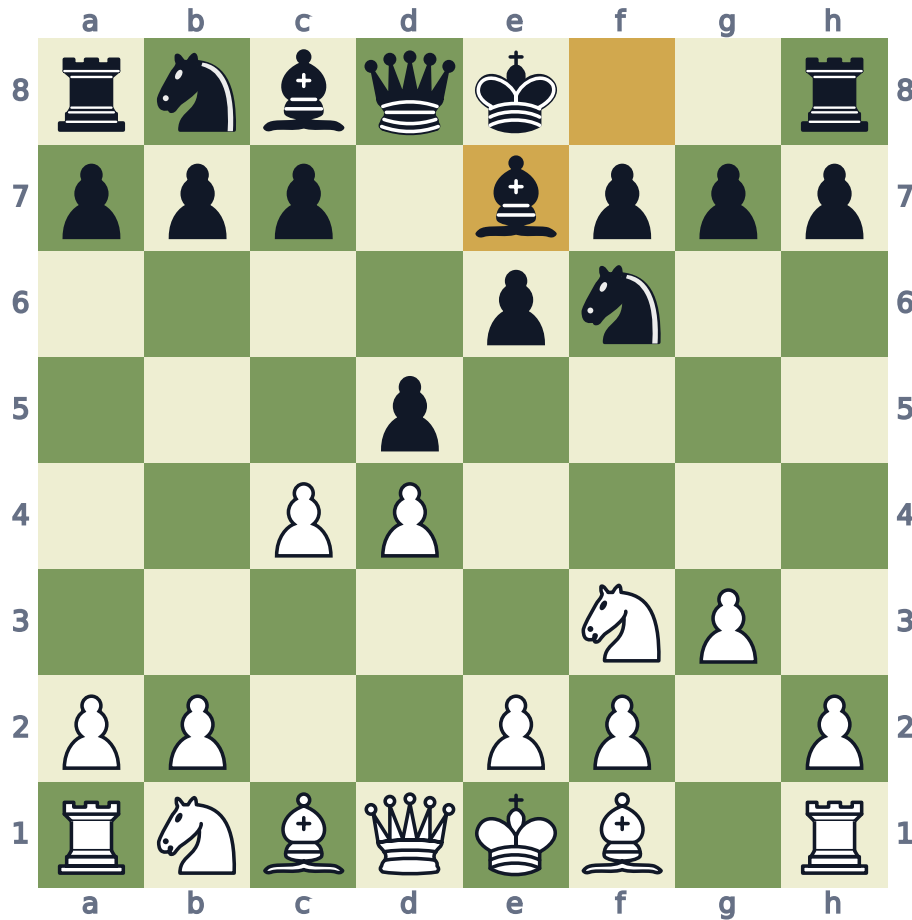
Position estimate: +0.60 for White (White is slightly better). Principal continuation: 1. Bb7 e5 2. Ne8 cxd5 3. exd5 Re1 4. Nc7 Nf1 5. Ne6

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 01

Closed Catalan core



YOUR TASK

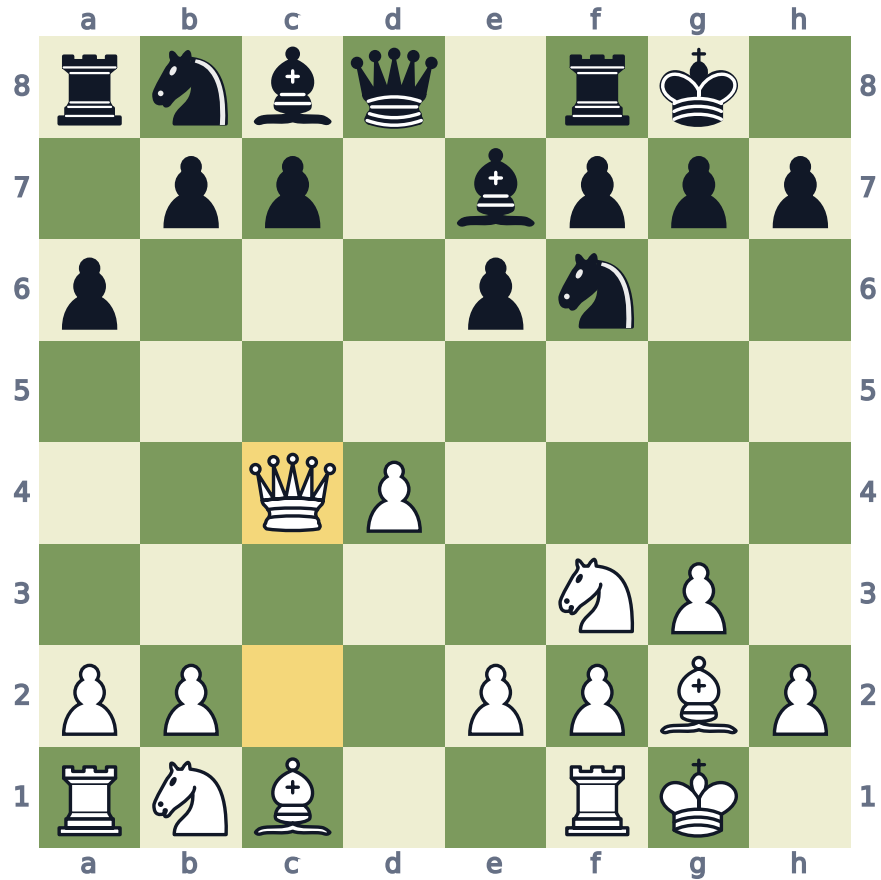
White to move. Name Black's opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give Black's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 02

Open Catalan recovery



COURSE LINE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 e6 3. Nf3 d5 4. g3 dxc4 5. Bg2 Be7 6. O-O O-O 7. Qc2 a6 8. Qxc4

WHITE'S IDEA

Recover c4 while preserving the bishop's diagonal and development lead.

MAIN DANGER

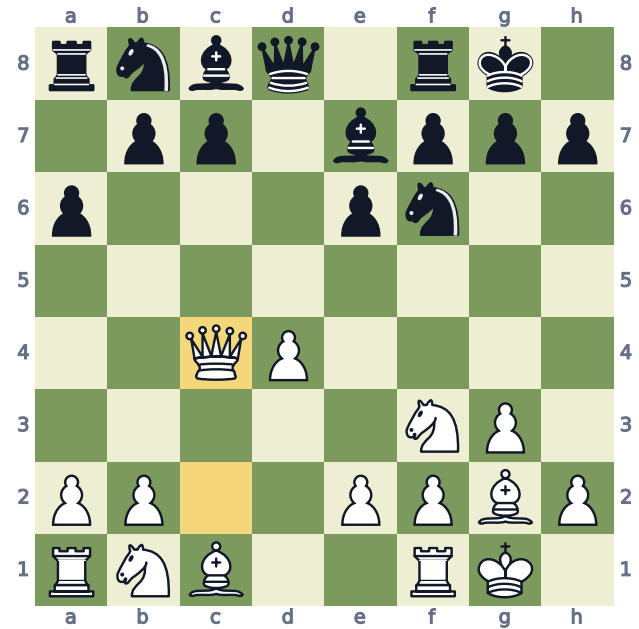
The queen on c4 can be chased by ...b5.

BRANCH LOGIC 02

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 6 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

Qc2 eyes c4 and h7 while avoiding early exposure.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

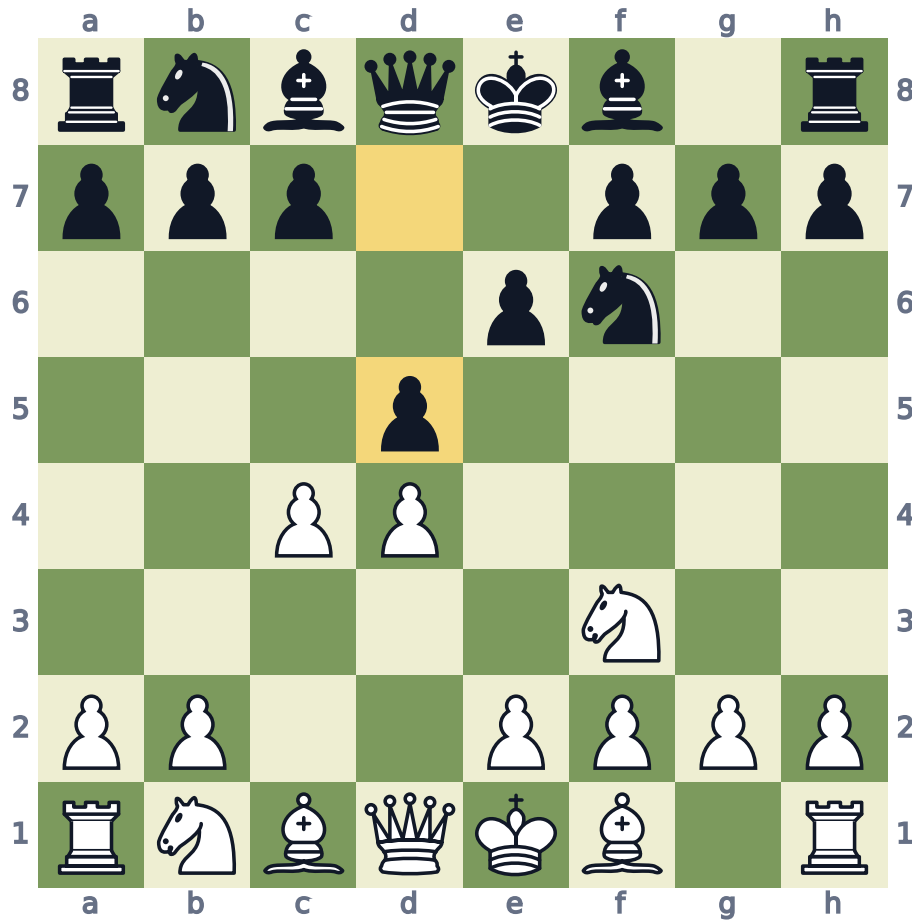
Position estimate: +0.11 for White (equal). Principal continuation: 1. b5 Qc2 2. Bb7 Bf4 3. Nc6 Nc3 4. Nb4 Qb3 5. c5 dxc5

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 02

Open Catalan recovery



YOUR TASK

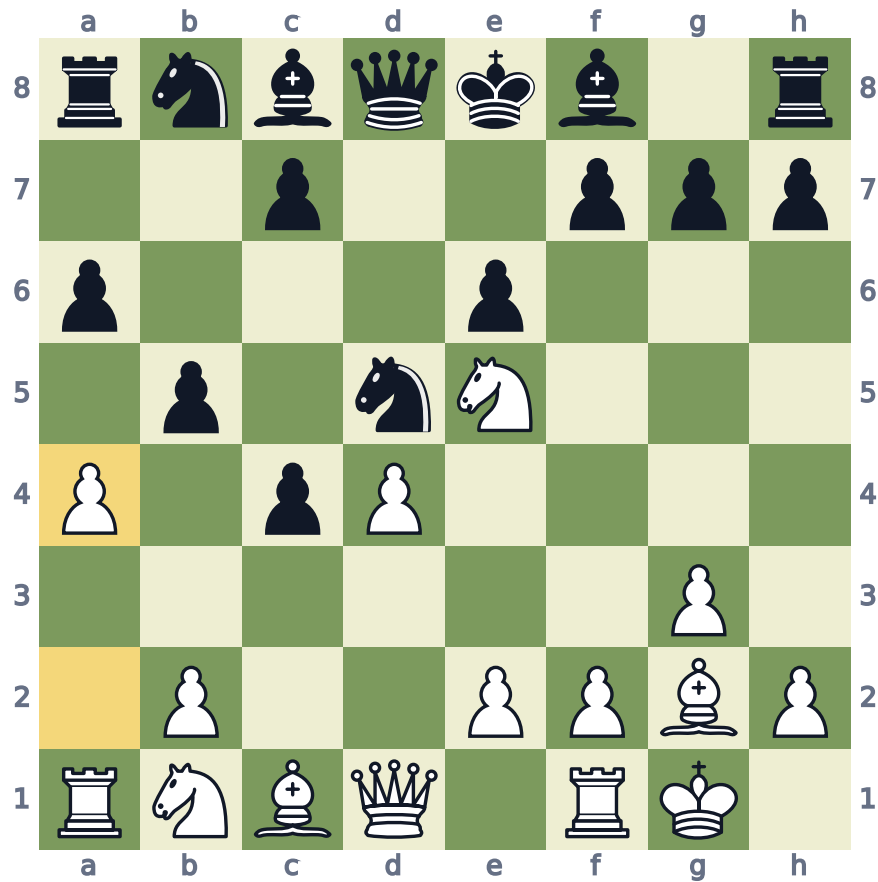
White to move. Name Black's opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give Black's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 03

Open Catalan with Qa4+



COURSE LINE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 e6 3. Nf3 d5 4. g3 dxc4 5. Bg2 a6 6. O-O b5 7. Ne5 Nd5 8. a4

WHITE'S IDEA

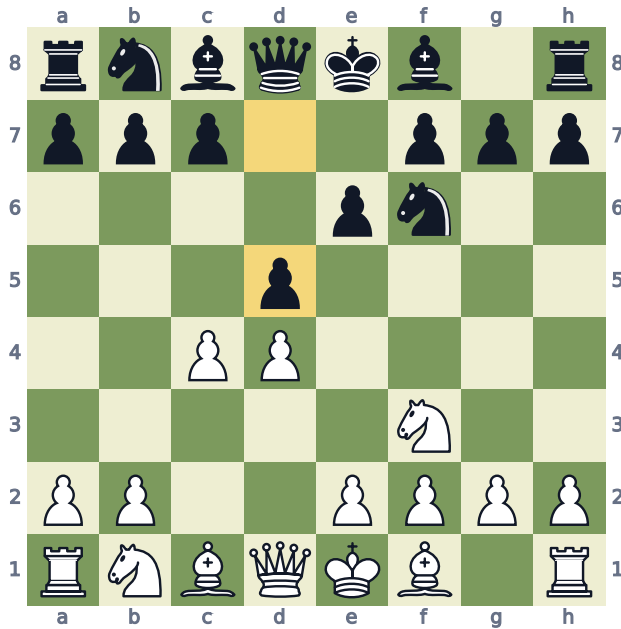
Use the center and long diagonal to undermine Black's pawn chain.

MAIN DANGER

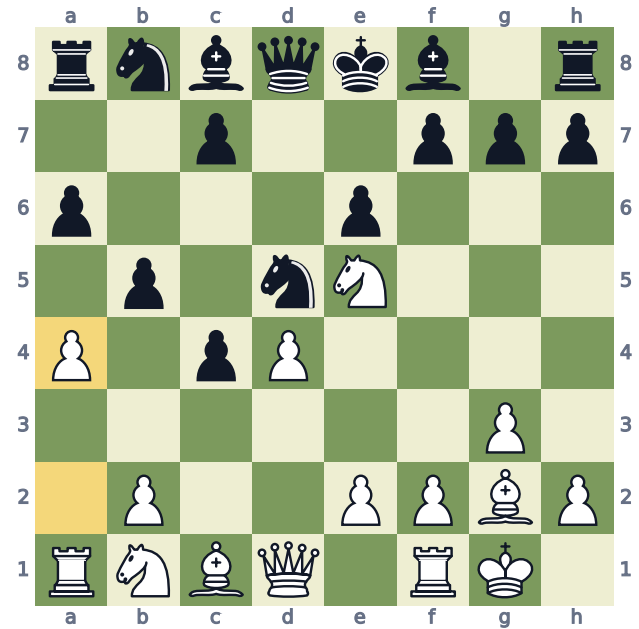
A premature axb5 can open useful files for Black.

BRANCH LOGIC 03

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 6 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

When Black holds c4 with ...b5, attack the chain with a4 and Ne5.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

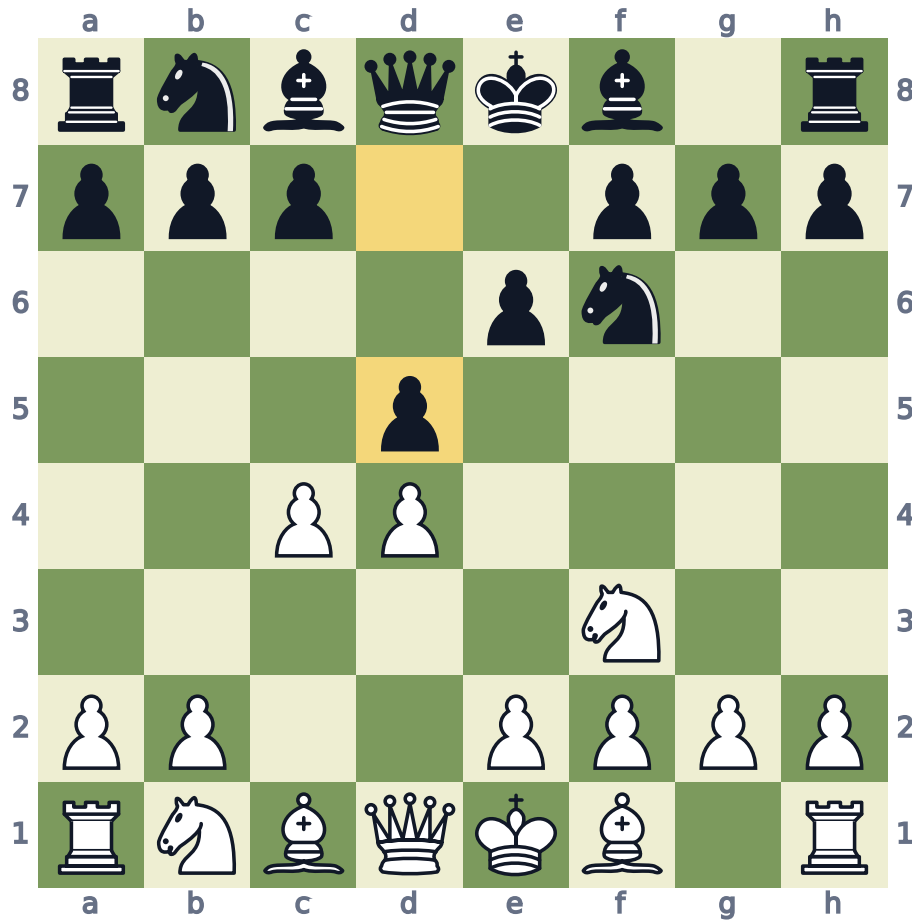
Position estimate: +0.78 for White (White is slightly better). Principal continuation: 1. Bb7 b3 2. cxb3 axb5 3. Be7 Qxb3

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 03

Open Catalan with Qa4+



YOUR TASK

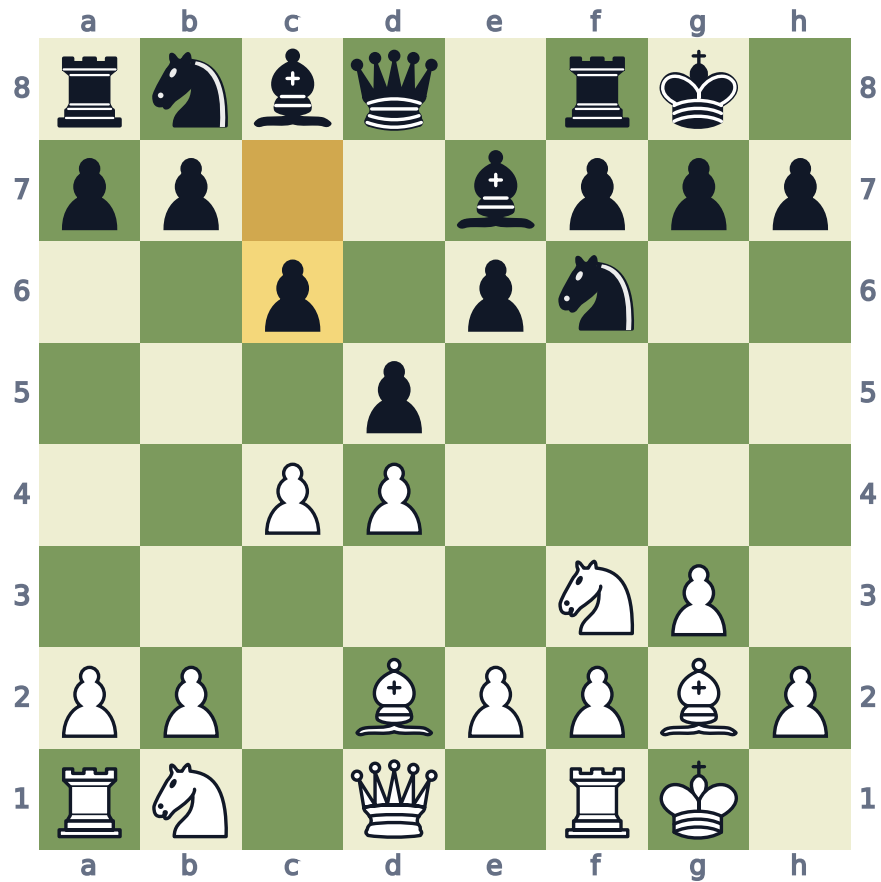
White to move. Name Black's opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give Black's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 04

Catalan ...Bb4+



COURSE LINE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 e6 3. Nf3 d5 4. g3 Bb4+ 5. Bd2 Be7 6. Bg2 O-O 7. O-O c6

WHITE'S IDEA

Meet the check with natural development and retain Catalan pressure.

MAIN DANGER

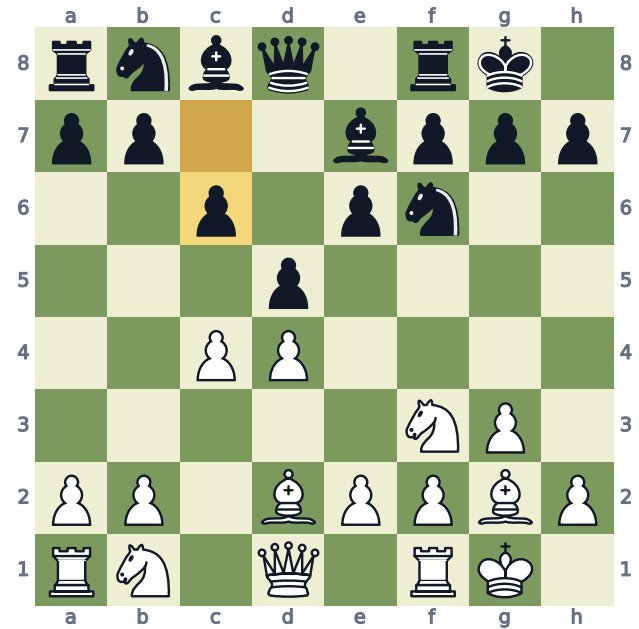
The bishop on d2 can obstruct queen pressure if left passive.

BRANCH LOGIC 04

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 6 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

Use the check to develop, then decide whether Bf4 or Qc2 improves the bishop.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

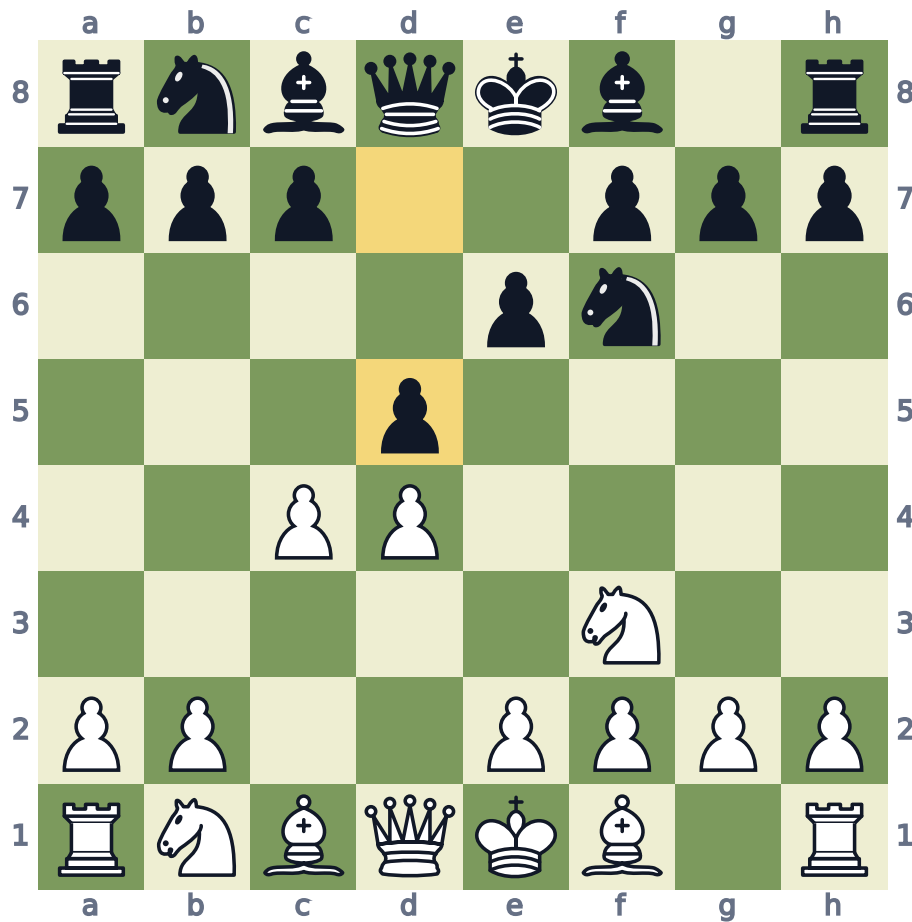
Position estimate: +0.27 for White (White is slightly better). Principal continuation: 1. Qc2 Nbd7 2. Bf4 b6 3. Rd1 Ba6

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 04

Catalan ...Bb4+



YOUR TASK

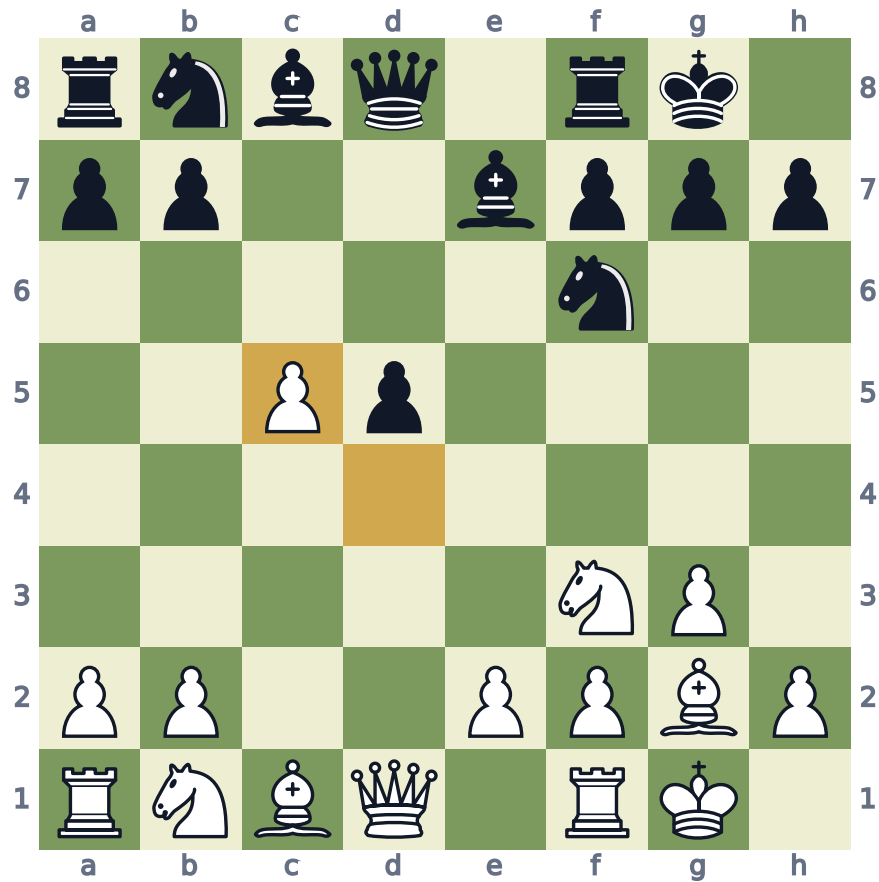
White to move. Name Black's opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give Black's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 05

Catalan ...c5 challenge



COURSE LINE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 e6 3. Nf3 d5 4. g3 Be7 5. Bg2 O-O 6. O-O c5 7. cxd5 exd5 8. dxc5

WHITE'S IDEA

Clarify the center when Black challenges before completing queenside development.

MAIN DANGER

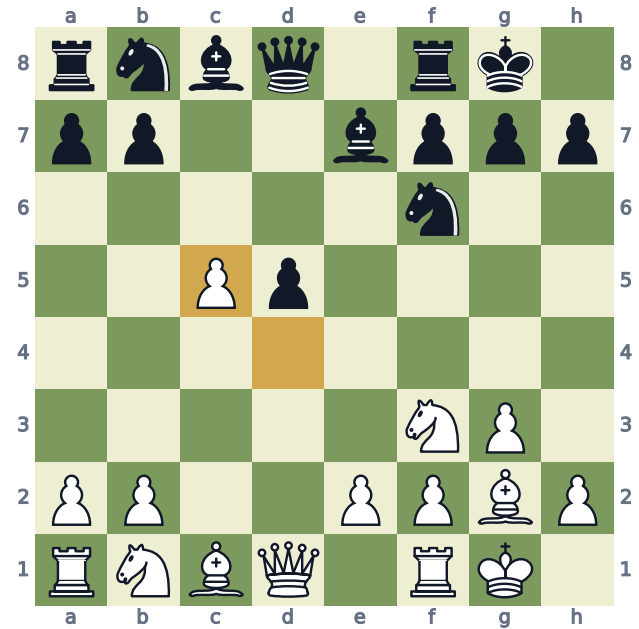
Exchanges can release Black's isolated pawn activity.

BRANCH LOGIC 05

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 6 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

Against ...c5, calculate whether dxc5 or maintaining tension improves the bishop.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

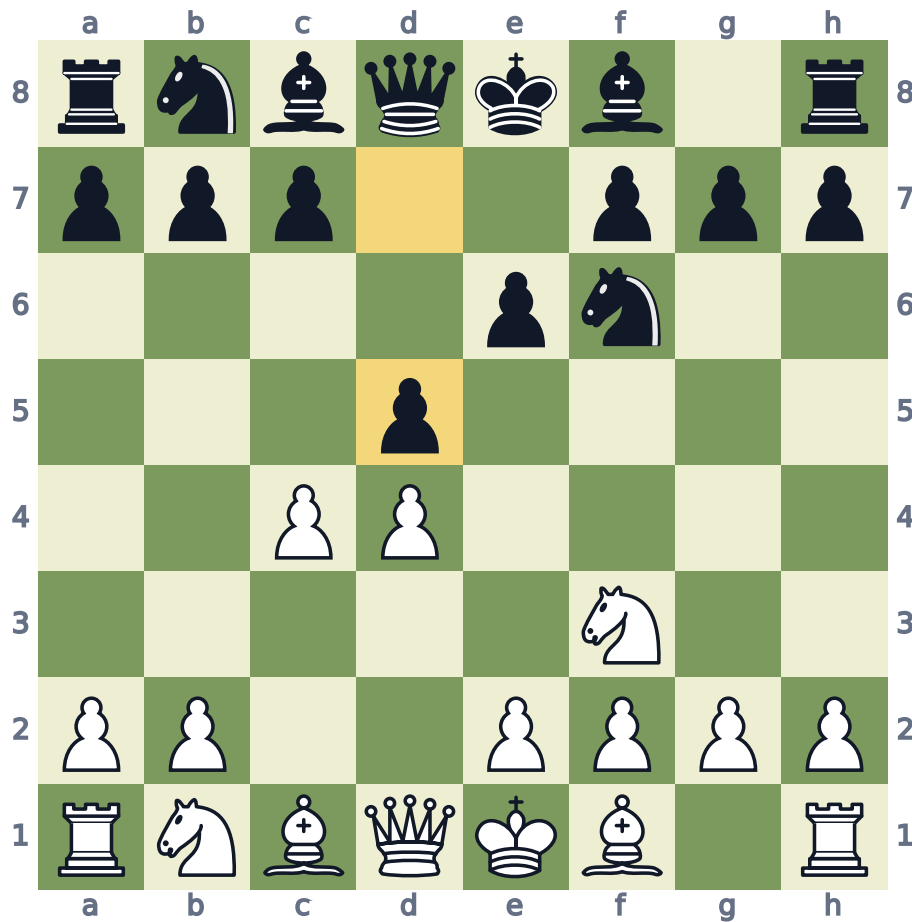
Position estimate: +0.51 for White (White is slightly better). Principal continuation: 1. Bxc5 b3 2. h6 Nc3 3. Be6 Bb2 4. Nc6 e3 5. Qe7 Ne2

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 05

Catalan ...c5 challenge



YOUR TASK

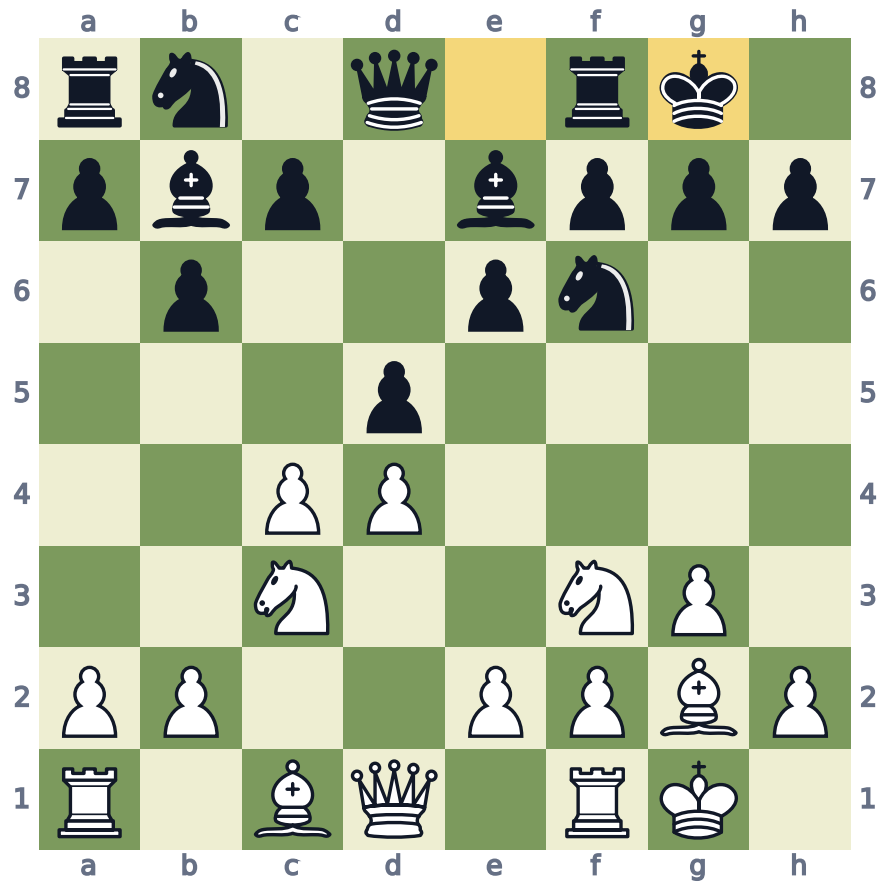
White to move. Name Black's opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give Black's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 06

Catalan ...b6



COURSE LINE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 e6 3. Nf3 d5 4. g3 b6 5. Bg2 Bb7 6. O-O Be7 7. Nc3 O-O

WHITE'S IDEA

Use normal development and prepare Ne5 or Qc2 against the queenside fianchetto.

MAIN DANGER

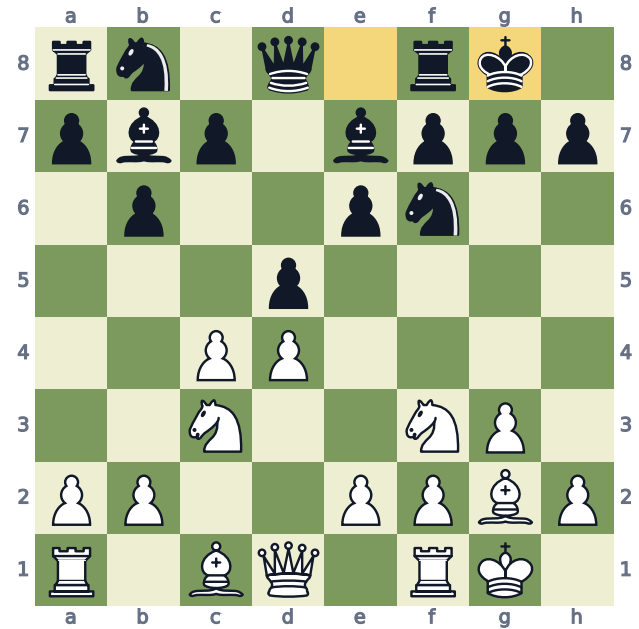
Both bishops can look impressive while the center remains blocked.

BRANCH LOGIC 06

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 6 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

When bishops face each other through d5, the central break decides their strength.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

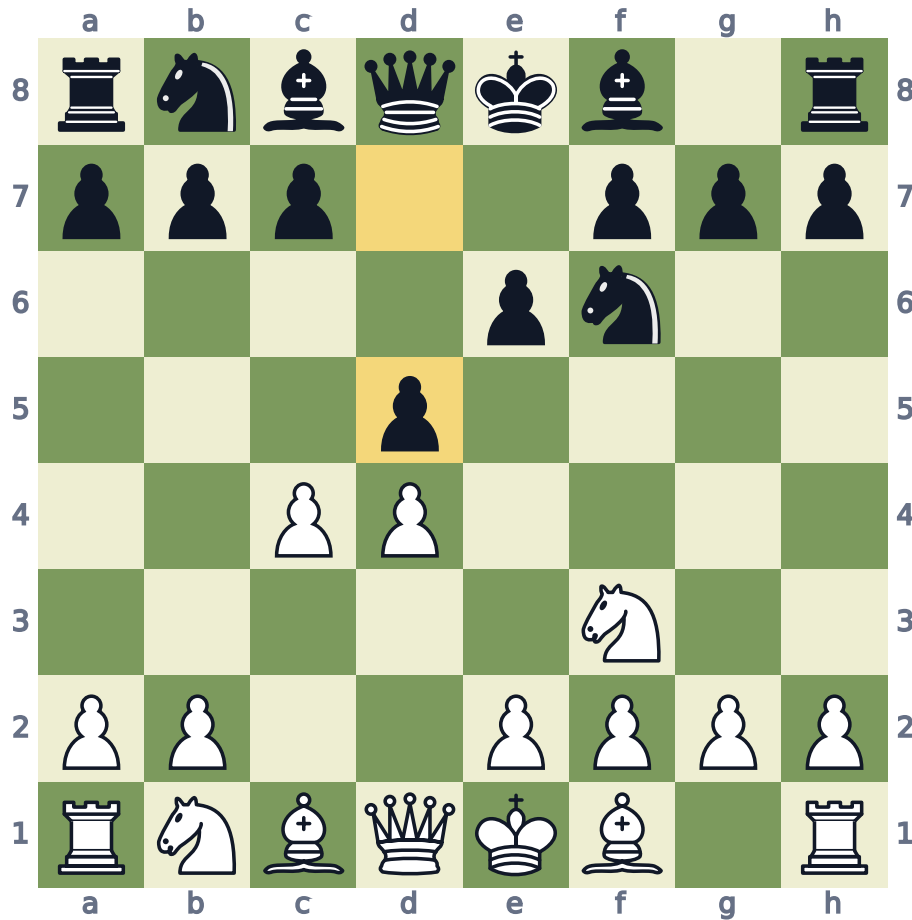
Position estimate: +0.55 for White (White is slightly better). Principal continuation: 1. cxd5 Nxd5 2. Qc2 Nxc3 3. bxc3

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 06

Catalan ...b6



YOUR TASK

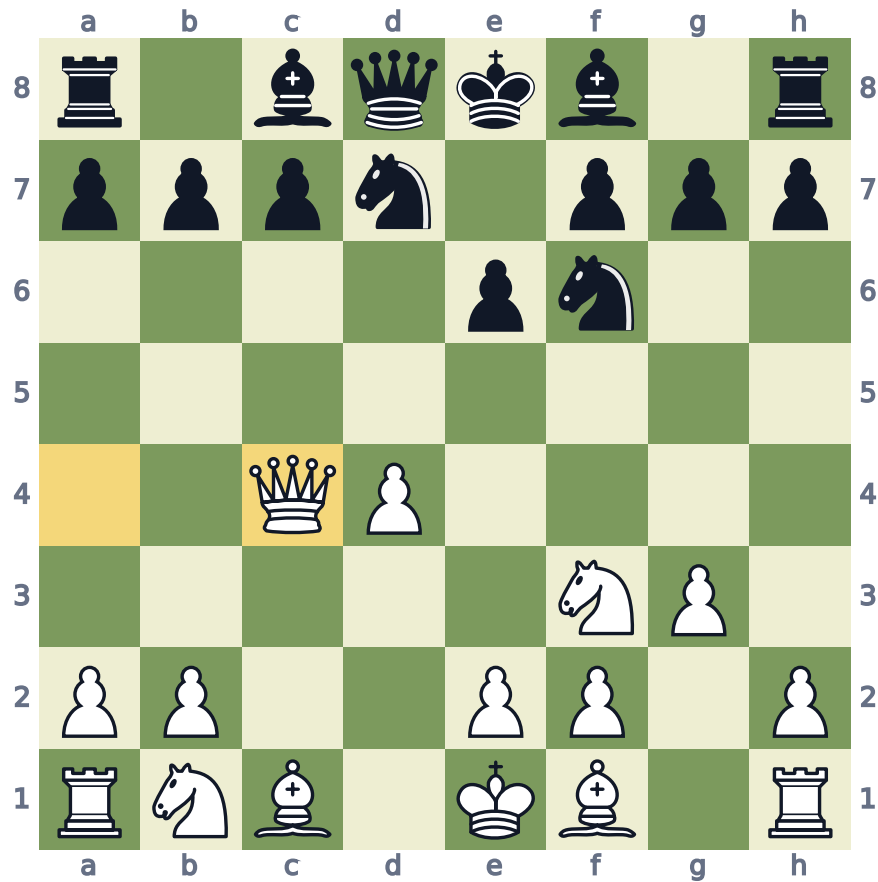
White to move. Name Black's opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give Black's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 07

Early ...dxc4



COURSE LINE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 e6 3. Nf3 d5 4. g3 dxc4 5. Qa4+ Nbd7 6. Qxc4

WHITE'S IDEA

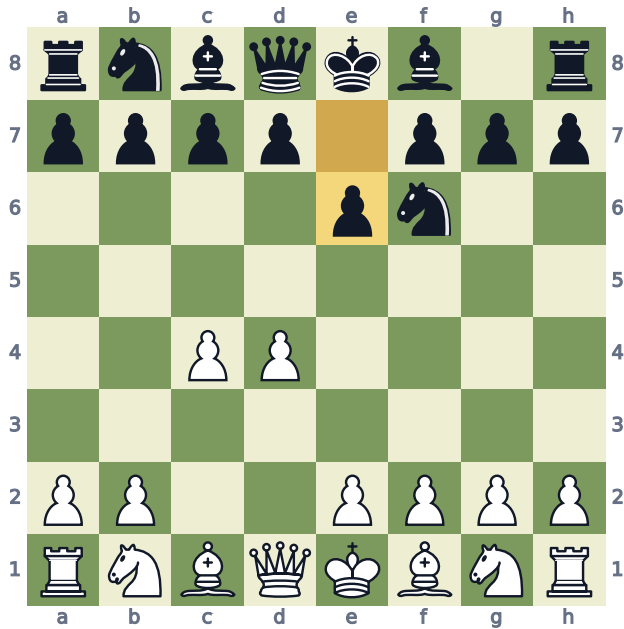
Use a forcing check to recover the pawn without losing development.

MAIN DANGER

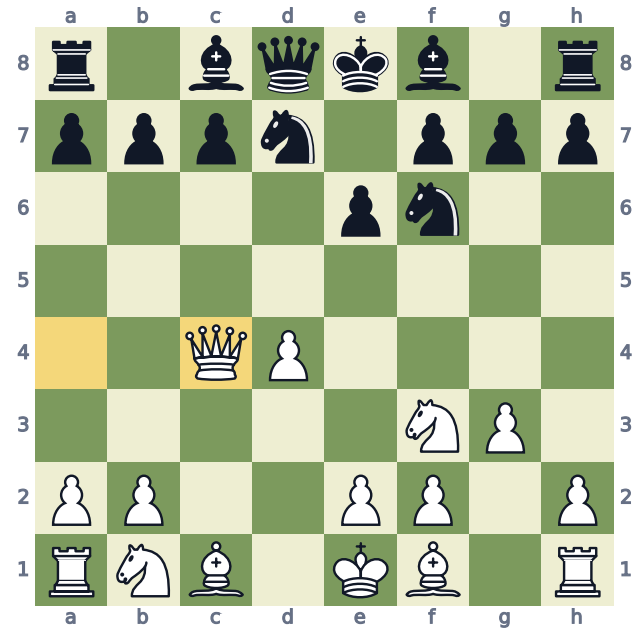
Queen checks are useful only when they improve placement rather than invite tempi.

BRANCH LOGIC 07

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 4 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

Qa4+ can force a blocking move and regain c4 immediately.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

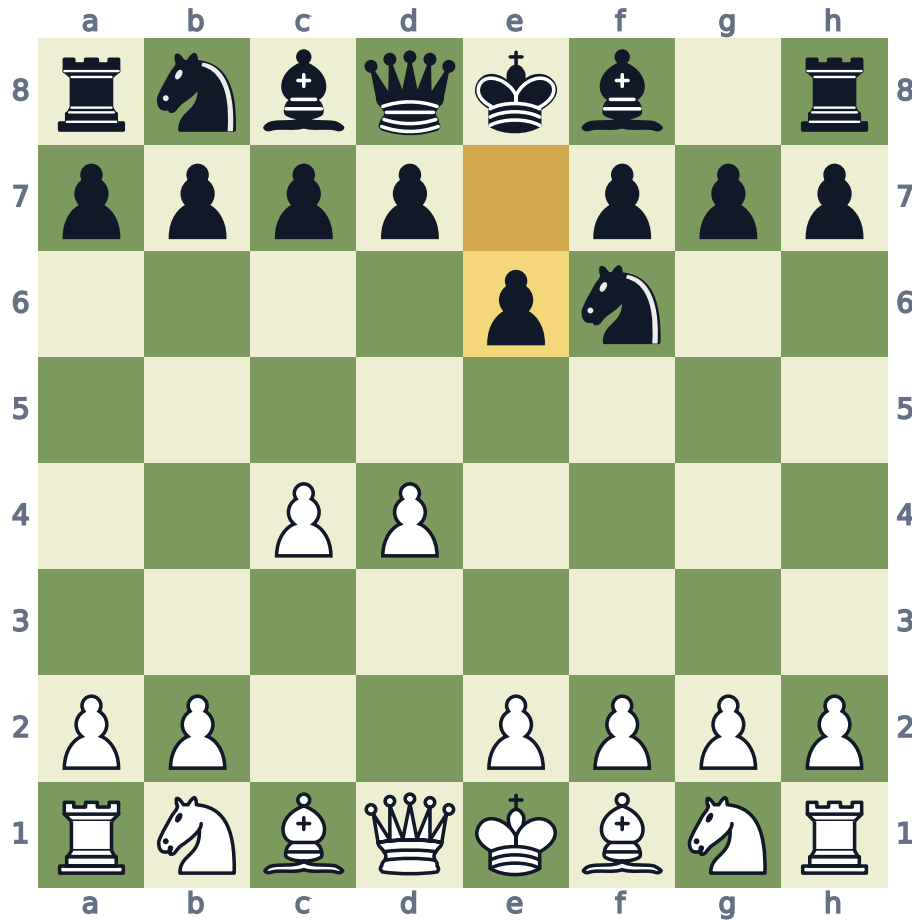
Position estimate: +0.07 for White (equal). Principal continuation: 1. a6 Bg2 2. b5 Qc2 3. Bb7 a4 4. c5 O-O 5. Rc8 axb5

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 07

Early ...dxc4



YOUR TASK

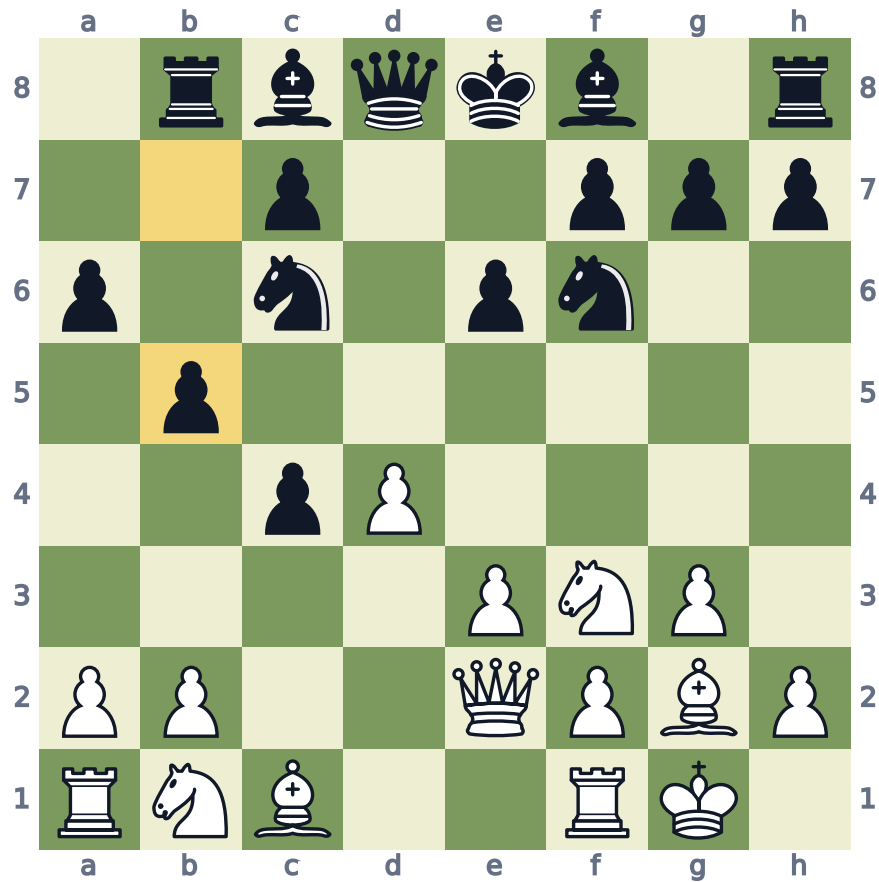
White to move. Name Black's opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give Black's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 08

Catalan endgame route



COURSE LINE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 e6 3. Nf3 d5 4. g3 dxc4 5. Bg2 a6 6. O-O Nc6 7. e3 Rb8 8. Qe2 b5

WHITE'S IDEA

Accept a long positional struggle and target queenside weaknesses after recovery.

MAIN DANGER

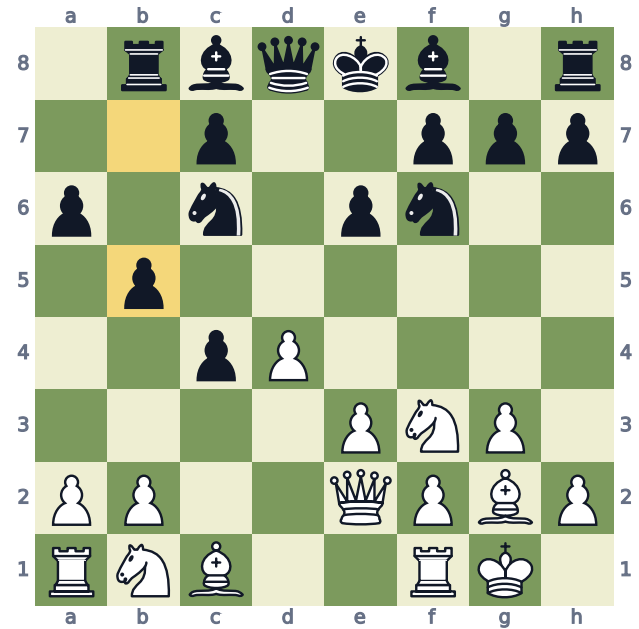
A pawn advantage is meaningless if Black keeps activity and files.

BRANCH LOGIC 08

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 8 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

Open Catalans often trade short-term material for durable squares and diagonals.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

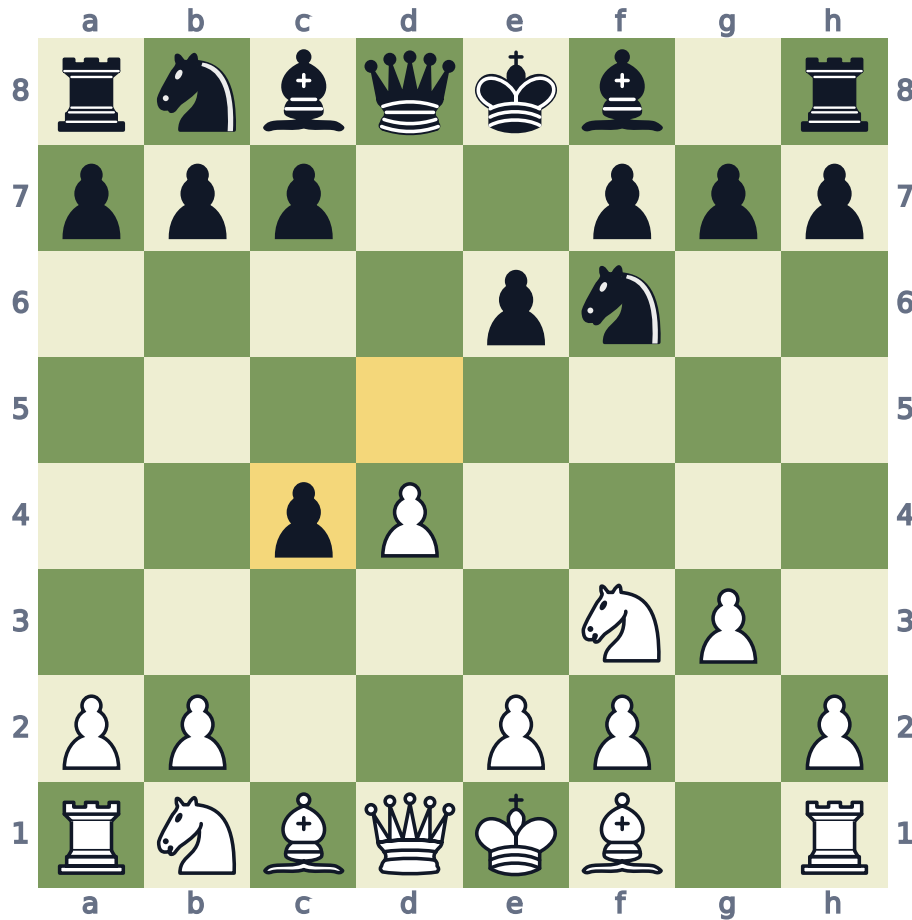
Position estimate: -0.08 for White (equal). Principal continuation: 1. b3 cxb3 2. Nfd2 Bb7 3. Nxb3 Be7 4. Rd1 Ba8

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 08

Catalan endgame route



YOUR TASK

White to move. Name Black's opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give Black's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

ANSWER SECTION

Recall solutions begin here

PROTECT THE TRAINING EFFECT

Do not read a solution until you have committed to a move and purpose. A matching move without the correct reason earns partial credit. If the course move is not the engine's first choice, compare plans rather than treating the engine as a memorization oracle.

ERROR LABELS

M = move-order memory | T = tactical oversight | P = plan misunderstanding | V = visualization | C = calculation | R = rushed recognition

REPAIR RULE

Every miss must produce a question you can use in future games. Example: 'When Black supports d5 with c6, which pawn break or recovery method does my repertoire use?'

SOLUTIONS

Answers 1-3

01. CLOSED CATALAN CORE

Course move: Bg2. Purpose: Complete the fianchetto and prepare e4 while the center remains closed. Engine comparison: 1. Bg2 O-O 2. O-O dxc4 3. Qc2 c5 4. dxc5 Bxc5 5. Qxc4 Qb6 (+0.47 for White (White is slightly better)). Warning: e4 without enough support can lose d4 or permit ...dxe4.

02. OPEN CATALAN RECOVERY

Course move: g3. Purpose: Recover c4 while preserving the bishop's diagonal and development lead. Engine comparison: 1. g3 Bb4+ 2. Bd2 Be7 3. Qc2 O-O 4. Bg2 b6 (+0.35 for White (White is slightly better)). Warning: The queen on c4 can be chased by ...b5.

03. OPEN CATALAN WITH QA4+

Course move: g3. Purpose: Use the center and long diagonal to undermine Black's pawn chain. Engine comparison: 1. g3 Bb4+ 2. Bd2 Be7 3. Qc2 O-O 4. Bg2 b6 (+0.35 for White (White is slightly better)). Warning: A premature axb5 can open useful files for Black.

SOLUTIONS

Answers 4-6

04. CATALAN ...BB4+

Course move: g3. Purpose: Meet the check with natural development and retain Catalan pressure. Engine comparison: 1. g3 Bb4+ 2. Bd2 Be7 3. Qc2 O-O 4. Bg2 b6 (+0.35 for White (White is slightly better)). Warning: The bishop on d2 can obstruct queen pressure if left passive.

05. CATALAN ...C5 CHALLENGE

Course move: g3. Purpose: Clarify the center when Black challenges before completing queenside development. Engine comparison: 1. g3 Bb4+ 2. Bd2 Be7 3. Qc2 O-O 4. Bg2 b6 (+0.35 for White (White is slightly better)). Warning: Exchanges can release Black's isolated pawn activity.

06. CATALAN ...B6

Course move: g3. Purpose: Use normal development and prepare Ne5 or Qc2 against the queenside fianchetto. Engine comparison: 1. g3 Bb4+ 2. Bd2 Be7 3. Qc2 O-O 4. Bg2 b6 (+0.35 for White (White is slightly better)). Warning: Both bishops can look impressive while the center remains blocked.

SOLUTIONS

Answers 7-8

07. EARLY ...DXC4

Course move: Nf3. Purpose: Use a forcing check to recover the pawn without losing development. Engine comparison: 1. g3 Bb4+ 2. Bd2 Be7 3. Qc2 c5 4. dxc5 Bxc5 5. Bg2 (+0.33 for White (White is slightly better)). Warning: Queen checks are useful only when they improve placement rather than invite tempi.

08. CATALAN ENDGAME ROUTE

Course move: Bg2. Purpose: Accept a long positional struggle and target queenside weaknesses after recovery. Engine comparison: 1. Bg2 Bb4+ 2. Bd2 a5 3. a3 Bxd2+ 4. Qxd2 Nbd7 5. O-O O-O (+0.29 for White (White is slightly better)). Warning: A pawn advantage is meaningless if Black keeps activity and files.

VOLUME REVIEW

Make the repertoire usable

REVIEW TASK 1

Reconstruct every branch from the first move without looking.

REVIEW TASK 2

For each branch, explain one Black plan and one White plan.

REVIEW TASK 3

Shuffle the recall positions so the chapter title cannot reveal the answer.

REVIEW TASK 4

Play each starting position against Fritz from both sides.

REVIEW TASK 5

Add mistakes from your own games to the PGN as new training positions.

REVIEW TASK 6

Retest the weakest three branches after 1, 3, 7, 14, 30, and 60 days.

GRADUATION STANDARD

Score at least 80 percent twice, one week apart, and explain every move in plain language. Then maintain the volume through your own games instead of rereading it continuously.